TG ACADEMY / EXECUTIVE LEARNING

FOCUS INTELLIGENCE

WEEK 4

UNDERSTANDING ATTENTION, CONCENTRATION AND PERSONAL FOCUS

Attention is a limited personal resource

01

ATTENTION

What you select to notice among competing inputs.

02

CONCENTRATION

The ability to stay with one chosen activity long enough to make progress.

03

FOCUS

Directing attention towards an outcome that matters.

04

SELF-REGULATION

Difficult conversations and responsibilities can consume attention even after they end.

TEACHING EXAMPLE • Notice how often your mind moves before judging your ability to concentrate.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

THE FOCUS CYCLE: CHOOSE, ENGAGE, NOTICE, RETURN

REFLECT & APPLY

Define one specific task and a visible finish point.

ENGAGE	Begin with a manageable period; remove obvious competing cues.
NOTICE	Catch wandering thoughts, discomfort or an incoming request.
RETURN	Refocus without restarting the entire day or criticising yourself.



TEACHING EXAMPLE • Practise a 10-minute focus cycle with a simple personal task.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

CASE REFLECTION: PRESENT BUT NOT ENGAGED

SITUATION	Leila sits down to complete an online course but repeatedly checks messages.
MISINTERPRETATION	She concludes that she lacks discipline, although her phone is in view.
REDESIGN	Put the phone out of sight, define one lesson and begin for 15 minutes.
MEASURE	Track lesson progress and the number of deliberate returns to task.



TEACHING EXAMPLE • Discuss the difference between a character judgement and an adjustable condition.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

RECOGNISING INTERNAL AND EXTERNAL DISTRACTIONS

Two sources of distraction

EXTERNAL

Alerts, background noise, interruptions, clutter and other people's requests.

INTERACTION

An external cue can trigger an internal worry or an urge to check something.

FOCUS SYSTEM

INTERNAL

Worry, fatigue, boredom, hunger, intrusive thoughts and competing ideas.

RESPONSE

Identify the cause before choosing an appropriate strategy.

TEACHING EXAMPLE • Name one distraction you can change and one that needs accommodation.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

BUILD A PERSONAL DISTRACTION MAP

TRIGGER

What happened immediately before attention shifted?

CONTEXT

Where were you, what time was it and how was your energy?

RESPONSE

What did you do next, and how long did it take to return?

ADJUSTMENT

What is one respectful, realistic change you can test?



TEACHING EXAMPLE • Observe three focus interruptions today; do not aim for perfect tracking.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

CASE LAB: DISTRACTION OR LEGITIMATE RESPONSIBILITY?

SCENARIO

Three times each day, rate your energy from 1 (very low) to 5 (very high).

DISTINCTION

Note sleep, meals, demanding responsibilities and how you felt before a task.

STRATEGY

Look for repeatable windows and exceptions rather than judging a single day.

REFLECTION

Move one meaningful task to a more suitable window and test the difference.

TEACHING EXAMPLE • Invite participants to design focus strategies that respect their circumstances.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

UNDERSTANDING MULTITASKING AND THE COST OF TASK-SWITCHING

Why switching feels productive



VISIBLE ACTIVITY

Moving among tasks creates the impression of momentum.



REORIENTATION

Each switch may require recalling context, goals and the next action.



ERROR RISK

Important details can be missed when attention is divided.



BETTER QUESTION

Which activities truly require simultaneous attention, and which do not?

TEACHING EXAMPLE • Contrast routine combinations with two demanding thinking tasks.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

SINGLE-TASKING WITHOUT RIGIDITY

BATCH

Group similar low-complexity activities where possible.

SEQUENCE

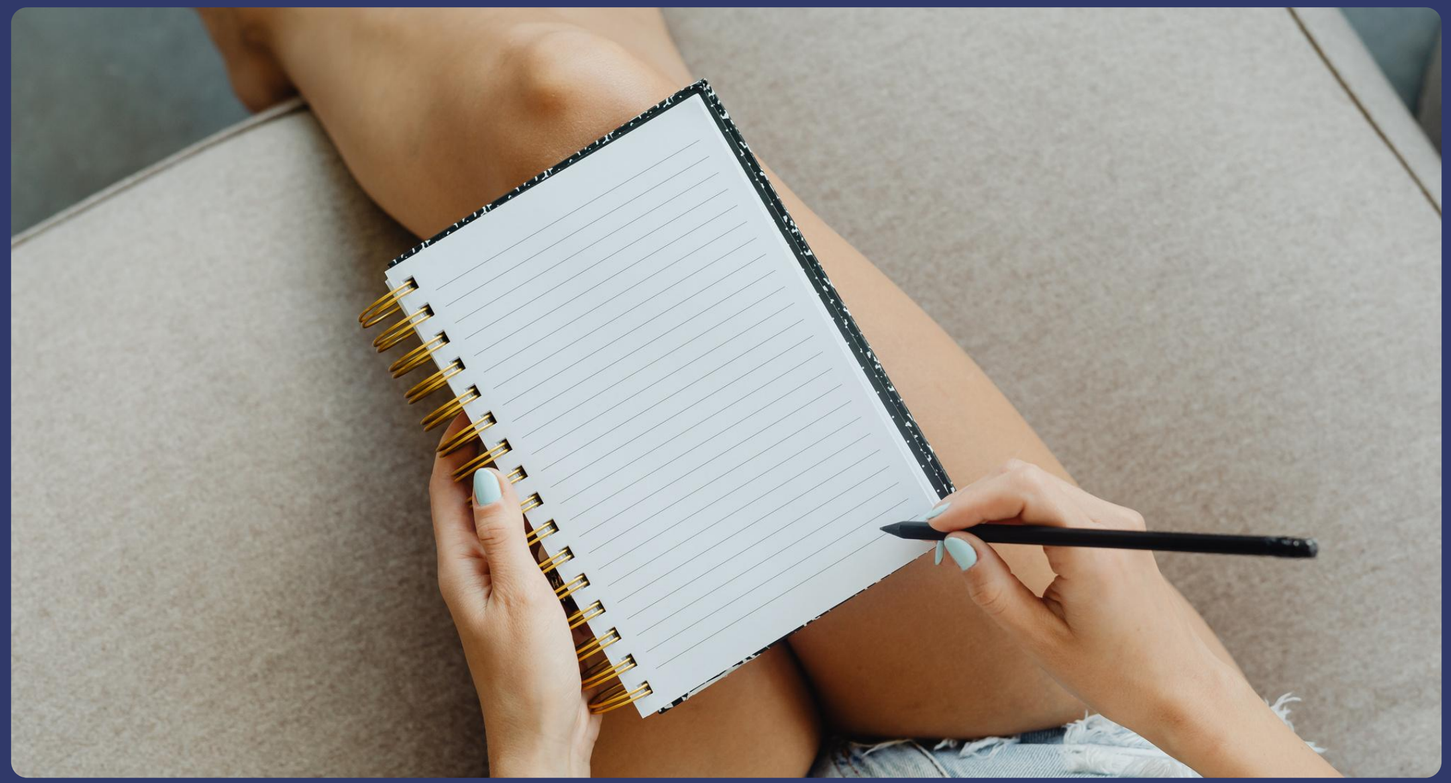
Finish a defined stage before moving to the next demanding task.

CAPTURE

Write down a new thought instead of acting on it immediately.

RECOVER

When interrupted, use a short note to resume from the last step.



TEACHING EXAMPLE • Create a “return point” note before your next necessary interruption.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

PERSONAL EXPERIMENT: TWO WAYS OF WORKING

REFLECT & APPLY

Spend 8 minutes alternating between a short reading and a written response.

ROUND B

Spend 8 minutes completing one defined task before switching.

COMPARE

Notice completion, errors, mental effort and satisfaction.

CAUTION

This is a learning demonstration, not a controlled scientific test.



TEACHING EXAMPLE • Ask which method felt calmer and why, without promising universal results.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

MANAGING DIGITAL DISTRACTIONS AND INTENTIONAL TECHNOLOGY USE

Digital tools: useful and attention-demanding

BENEFIT	Devices support learning, connection, accessibility and daily responsibilities.
ATTENTION CUES	Badges, autoplay, alerts and feeds can prompt repeated checking.
DEFAULT HABITS	Opening an app can become automatic during discomfort or delay.
INTENTIONAL USE	Choose a purpose and stopping point before entering a digital space.

TEACHING EXAMPLE • Distinguish necessary connectivity from automatic checking.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

DESIGN A PERSONAL DIGITAL BOUNDARY

Two sources of distraction

NOTIFICATIONS

Keep essential alerts; silence non-essential ones during focus.

ACCESS WINDOWS

Choose realistic check-in moments around personal responsibilities.

FOCUS SYSTEM

VISIBILITY

Move distracting apps or devices out of immediate view.

EXIT RULE

Define what “finished” means before opening a platform.

TEACHING EXAMPLE • Select one change to test for five days; retain emergency access.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

CASE LAB: THE FIVE-MINUTE SCROLL

Why switching feels productive



TRIGGER

Jon opens a social app while waiting for a document to load.



PATTERN

A short pause turns into repeated browsing and delayed work.



ALTERNATIVE

Keep a brief offline next-action list for waiting periods.



REVIEW

Compare intended and actual use without moralising screen time.

TEACHING EXAMPLE • Ask participants to choose a replacement that feels practical rather than punitive.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

DEVELOPING SUSTAINED FOCUS HABITS AND CONCENTRATION ROUTINES

Build focus through repeatable cues

1
START RITUAL

Clear one space, open the needed material and name the next step.

2
TIME BOX

Choose a duration suited to current energy and task complexity.

3
PROGRESS SIGNAL

Use a checklist, paragraph count or finished section.

4
CLOSE RITUAL

Record where to restart and take an appropriate break.

TEACHING EXAMPLE • Design a routine you could repeat on an ordinary busy day.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

THE FOCUS INTERVAL: QUALITY OVER ENDURANCE

BEFORE

Define a single outcome and check essential responsibilities.

DURING

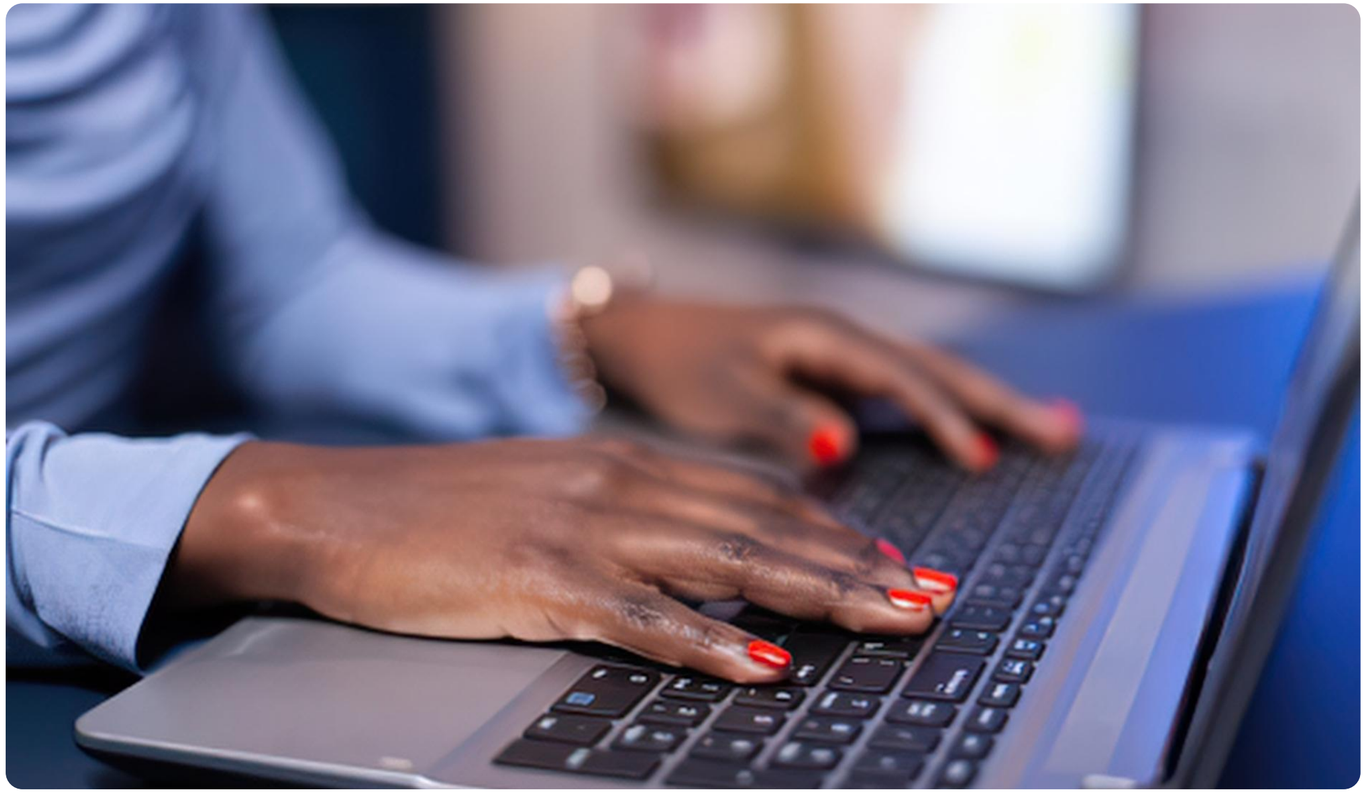
Work on one meaningful activity; capture unrelated thoughts.

BREAK

Move, hydrate, rest or meet a necessary personal need.

AFTER

Evaluate progress and adjust interval length to your capacity.



TEACHING EXAMPLE • Try 15–25 minutes as an example, not a mandatory standard.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

CASE REFLECTION: REBUILDING CONCENTRATION

START

What drains my capacity most—and what helps restore it?

ADJUST

Which commitment will I reduce, redesign or negotiate?

PROGRESS

Which realistic time and energy window will I preserve?

LEARNING

How will I know next week that my plan is more sustainable?



TEACHING EXAMPLE • Have learners rewrite one unrealistic focus expectation.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

CREATING BOUNDARIES AND AN ENVIRONMENT THAT SUPPORTS FOCUS

Your environment shapes your choices

REFLECT & APPLY
Lighting, seating, materials, noise and visual clutter.

SOCIAL
Shared spaces, care needs, availability expectations and interruptions.

EMOTIONAL
Pressure, fear of missing out and guilt about saying no.

PRACTICAL
A usable setup can be simple, portable and inexpensive.

TEACHING EXAMPLE • Ask which method felt calmer and why, without promising universal results.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

COMMUNICATE A FOCUS BOUNDARY RESPECTFULLY

STATE THE NEED	“I need 25 minutes to finish this assignment.”
NAME AVAILABILITY	“I can respond afterwards; urgent matters can reach me here.”
OFFER AN OPTION	“Can we speak at 4 pm instead?”
REVISIT	Adjust the boundary when circumstances or responsibilities change.

TEACHING EXAMPLE • Role-play a respectful request in a shared household or study setting.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

SCENARIO: NO PRIVATE WORKSPACE

CONSTRAINT

Malik shares a small home and cannot control household noise.

REALISM

Not every barrier can be solved by willpower or negotiation.

FOCUS SYSTEM

POSSIBILITIES

Use headphones if suitable, a library, an agreed short window or a portable kit.

SUCCESS

Choose a repeatable, low-friction arrangement that fits his life.



TEACHING EXAMPLE • Invite two alternatives for someone with limited space and limited money.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

DESIGNING A PERSONAL FOCUS SYSTEM AND MEASURING PROGRESS

The six-part personal focus system

PURPOSE

Know the meaningful task you are protecting.

WINDOW

Choose a realistic period based on energy and obligations.

ENVIRONMENT

Reduce avoidable cues while retaining essential access.

RETURN PLAN

Capture interruptions and record how to resume.

RECOVERY

Allow breaks, rest and changing capacity.

REVIEW

Notice what worked and adapt rather than blame yourself.

TEACHING EXAMPLE • Choose the two elements that would most improve your next week.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

CREATE A SIMPLE PERSONAL FOCUS SCORECARD

FOCUS BLOCKS

How many planned sessions did you attempt and complete?

MEANINGFUL OUTPUT

What useful step or outcome did you achieve?

INTERRUPTIONS

What caused drift, and how quickly did you return?

WELLBEING

Was the approach manageable and compatible with rest?

TEACHING EXAMPLE • Track patterns for one week; avoid turning the scorecard into another burden.

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.

WEEK 4 INTEGRATION: YOUR SEVEN-DAY FOCUS EXPERIMENT

CHOOSE

Name one priority that needs more protected attention.

DESIGN

Select a focus window, start cue and digital boundary.

PRACTISE

Test the routine on three or more suitable days.

REVIEW

Keep what helped, adapt what failed and carry learning into Week 5.



TEACHING EXAMPLE • Exit reflection: “My most helpful focus change will be ___ because ___.”

PERSONAL PRACTICE • Identify one realistic change and how you will assess it.



THANK YOU

Any Question?